

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP U.S. History Free-Response Practice Exam 1

APUSH-SAQ1-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 2 — Period 2: 1607–1754

Period: Period 2: 1607–1754

Theme: WXT — Work, Exchange, and Technology

Historical Reasoning: Comparison

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source A: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation.

A historian of colonial labor argues that the Chesapeake colonies developed around a plantation economy in which access to land, staple-crop production, and coerced labor shaped political power and social hierarchy. According to this interpretation, the region’s economy encouraged a small elite of large planters to dominate local institutions.

Source B: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation.

A historian of colonial New England argues that the region’s economy developed through mixed farming, commerce, fishing, shipbuilding, and town-based institutions. According to this interpretation, New England’s social structure was shaped less by large staple plantations and more by family labor, church communities, and local self-government.

- (a) Describe one major difference between the colonial Chesapeake and colonial New England reflected in the two interpretations.
- (b) Explain one historical factor that contributed to the development of the Chesapeake economy described in Source A.
- (c) Explain one historical factor that contributed to the development of New England society or economy described in Source B.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid difference, such as the Chesapeake’s reliance on staple-crop plantation agriculture and enslaved or indentured labor compared with New England’s more diversified economy and town-centered social organization.
- (b) 1 point: Explains a relevant factor contributing to Chesapeake development, such as tobacco cultivation, fertile tidewater land, demand for export crops, headright policies, indentured servitude, or the expansion of racial slavery.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a relevant factor contributing to New England development, such as Puritan migration, colder climate and shorter growing season, family-based settlement, congregational churches, town meetings, Atlantic trade, fishing, or shipbuilding.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should do more than identify “North versus South.” It should connect regional differences to specific environmental, economic, labor, or cultural factors. The best responses will explain how colonial conditions shaped institutions and social hierarchy rather than treating regional differences as accidental.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ1-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 4 — Period 4: 1800–1848

Period: Period 4: 1800–1848

Theme: PCE — Politics and Power

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Original simulated source based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

A Cherokee community member writing to a missionary newspaper, Georgia, 1831.

“Our families have built farms, schools, and churches, and our council has adopted written laws so that our neighbors may see we are not wandering strangers. Yet the state claims our land as if our homes were empty. We are told that removal will protect us, but protection that begins by taking a person’s country is difficult to trust. I ask Christian readers to consider whether a nation can call itself just while refusing to honor its own treaties.”

- (a) Identify one historical development that shaped the situation described in the source.
- (b) Explain how the author’s point of view likely influenced the argument made in the source.
- (c) Explain one way the source reflects broader debates about federal power, state power, or Native sovereignty during the early nineteenth century.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a relevant development, such as Indian Removal, Georgia’s efforts to extend authority over Cherokee lands, the discovery of gold in Georgia, the Indian Removal Act of 1830, Cherokee adoption of written laws, or treaty disputes.
- (b) 1 point: Explains that the author’s perspective as a Cherokee person defending community land, sovereignty, and adaptation to Euro-American institutions shaped the source’s appeal to justice, treaties, Christianity, or legal rights.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a broader debate, such as conflict between state authority and federal treaty obligations, Jacksonian democracy’s limits, Native sovereignty, the role of the Supreme Court, or expansionist pressure on Indigenous nations.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should connect the source to Indian Removal without reducing the issue to a simple story of westward expansion. It should recognize Cherokee agency and explain how arguments about law, treaties, Christianity, and sovereignty were used to challenge removal.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ1-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 8 — Period 8: 1945–1980

Period: Period 8: 1945–1980

Theme: MIG — Migration and Settlement
Historical Reasoning: Continuity and Change Over Time
Source Type: Non-text source
Prompt:
Source: Described data table created for this practice exam.

The table is titled “Selected Indicators of Suburban Growth in the United States, 1945–1970.”

Indicator	1945	1970
Percentage of U.S. population living in suburbs	about 19%	about 37%
Single-family housing starts per year	fewer than 400,000	more than 1,000,000
Miles of interstate highway completed	0	more than 35,000
Share of new federally backed mortgages going primarily to white borrowers	very high	still disproportionately high
Many central cities	wartime housing shortages	population loss and tax-base decline

The table notes that these figures are approximate and are intended to show broad historical trends rather than exact annual totals.

- (a) Describe one major change in American settlement patterns reflected in the table.
- (b) Explain one federal policy or economic factor that contributed to the change shown in the table.
- (c) Explain one social consequence of the suburban growth reflected in the table.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes suburbanization, such as the growth of suburban population, expansion of single-family housing, or movement away from central cities after World War II.
- (b) 1 point: Explains a relevant cause, such as GI Bill benefits, federally backed mortgages, FHA or VA lending, highway construction, rising postwar incomes, automobile ownership, baby boom housing demand, or mass-produced suburban housing.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a relevant consequence, such as racial segregation, white flight, central-city tax decline, dependence on automobiles, gendered expectations of domestic life, expansion of consumer culture, or unequal access to wealth-building through homeownership.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should connect the table to postwar economic growth and federal policy, not just personal preference for suburban living. Strong responses may also explain how suburbanization expanded opportunity for some Americans while reinforcing racial and class inequalities.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-DBQ1-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 6 — Period 6: 1865–1898

Period: Cross-Period / Thematic

Theme: PCE — Politics and Power

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which federal policies transformed Native nations' land, sovereignty, and citizenship status from the 1880s through the 1930s.

Document 1

Author/Origin: Summary of a congressional reform speech by a Protestant Indian reform advocate, Washington, D.C., 1886.

Source Type: Reform speech summary.

The speaker argued that reservations kept Native people “separate from American progress” and claimed that dividing tribal lands into individual farms would encourage private property, Christian family life, and citizenship. The speaker also insisted that “surplus” lands should be opened to non-Native settlement so that western lands could become more productive.

Sourcing Cues: The speaker represented Protestant reform circles that often criticized violence against Native peoples while also promoting assimilation and private property as solutions.

Document 2

Author/Origin: Original simulated letter from a Lakota parent to a reservation agent, Dakota Territory, 1891; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Primary text source.

“My son returned from the school speaking little of our language and ashamed of the hair his grandmother once braided. You say this will prepare him for citizenship, but he was not asked whether he wished to forget the songs of his relatives. If farming is to be taught, why must children be taken far from those who know the land?”

Sourcing Cues: The author writes from the perspective of a Native parent responding to off-reservation boarding-school policies and assimilation efforts.

Document 3

Author/Origin: Described federal land table created for this practice exam from broad historical patterns, United States, 1887–1934.

Source Type: Data table.

The table is titled “Approximate Native Landholdings in the United States, 1887–1934.”

Year	Approximate Native land base
1887	about 138 million acres
1900	about 78 million acres
1910	about 52 million acres
1934	about 48 million acres

A note beneath the table states: “The steepest losses occurred after allotment policies divided communally held reservation lands and opened so-called surplus lands to non-Native purchase.”

Sourcing Cues: The table emphasizes land loss and invites analysis of how federal policy affected Native sovereignty and economic life.

Document 4

Author/Origin: Original simulated editorial from a western town newspaper, Oklahoma Territory, 1901; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Newspaper-style excerpt.

“Allotment has brought order where tribal uncertainty once discouraged investment. Rail lines, farms, and towns can now flourish. The Indian who accepts his parcel and works it as a citizen will benefit from the same laws as his neighbors. The unused lands should not remain closed while thousands of families seek homes.”

Sourcing Cues: The editorial reflects the viewpoint of non-Native settlers, business interests, and expansion advocates who supported allotment and land opening.

Document 5

Author/Origin: Described photograph from an off-reservation boarding school, Pennsylvania, circa 1905.

Source Type: Described photograph.

The photograph shows rows of Native students in military-style uniforms standing in front of a brick school building. Their hair is cut short, and several students hold farming tools or sewing materials for display. A caption written by the school reads: “Training for useful American citizenship.”

Sourcing Cues: The image was likely staged by school officials to present assimilation as orderly, disciplined, and successful.

Document 6

Author/Origin: Original simulated testimony by a Pueblo community leader before a federal commission, New Mexico, 1924; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Primary text source.

“We are told that citizenship has been given to us, yet our water, fields, and ceremonies remain the foundation of our community. Citizenship should not mean that our villages lose the authority to govern local matters or that our children are taught to despise their own people.”

Sourcing Cues: The testimony reflects Native concerns that U.S. citizenship could coexist uneasily with tribal sovereignty, community landholding, and cultural survival.

Document 7

Author/Origin: Summary of a federal policy statement associated with the Indian New Deal, Washington, D.C., 1934.

Source Type: Government policy summary.

The statement criticized earlier allotment policies for weakening tribal communities and reducing Native landholdings. It called for ending further allotment, supporting tribal self-government, and encouraging Native communities to organize councils under federally approved constitutions.

Sourcing Cues: The policy reflected a New Deal-era shift toward limited recognition of tribal self-government, though still within federal oversight.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible claim that evaluates the extent to which federal policies transformed Native land, sovereignty, and citizenship status from the 1880s through the 1930s. The thesis must make an argument, such as that federal policy dramatically reduced Native land and promoted assimilation while later reforms partially reversed allotment without fully restoring sovereignty.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader relevant context, such as westward expansion, the reservation system, military conflict on the Plains, the closing of the frontier, Progressive reform, assimilation ideology, or New Deal reform.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point for accurately using content from at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points for using content from at least six documents to support a coherent argument about land loss, assimilation, citizenship, sovereignty, or policy change.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point for using at least one specific, relevant piece of outside evidence not found in the documents, such as the Dawes Severalty Act, Carlisle Indian Industrial School, Ghost Dance movement, Wounded Knee massacre, Curtis Act, Indian

Citizenship Act of 1924, Meriam Report, Indian Reorganization Act, or specific tribal resistance to allotment.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. For example, a student might analyze reformers' assimilationist assumptions, settlers' economic motives, staged school photography, Native testimony defending sovereignty, or New Deal officials' critique of earlier policy.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced argument, such as explaining both continuity and change in federal power, showing that citizenship could expand legal status while threatening sovereignty, distinguishing between reformers' intentions and Native experiences, or explaining that the Indian New Deal marked a shift but did not end federal control.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ would likely argue that federal policy transformed Native life to a large extent by dividing communal land, expanding non-Native settlement, and using schooling and citizenship to promote assimilation. However, it should also recognize limits and changes: Native communities resisted cultural destruction, citizenship did not automatically protect sovereignty, and New Deal reforms partially rejected allotment while keeping federal oversight. Useful document groupings include assimilationist reformers and school officials, non-Native settlers and economic interests, Native community voices, land-loss evidence, and New Deal policy change. Relevant outside evidence could include the Dawes Act, Carlisle, the Indian Citizenship Act, the Meriam Report, or the Indian Reorganization Act.

Expected Points:

7

APUSH-LEQ1-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 5 — Period 5: 1844–1877

Period: Cross-Period / Thematic

Theme: NAT — American and National Identity

Historical Reasoning: Continuity and Change Over Time

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

From the era of the American Revolution through Reconstruction, Americans repeatedly debated who belonged within the political nation and what rights citizenship should include. These debates involved issues such as republican ideology, property and voting qualifications, slavery, women's rights, immigration, Native sovereignty, emancipation, and the constitutional changes of Reconstruction.

Evaluate the extent to which ideas about citizenship in the United States changed from 1763 to 1877.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible thesis that evaluates the extent of change in ideas about citizenship from 1763 to 1877. The thesis must make an argument about change, continuity, or both.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader context relevant to citizenship debates, such as British imperial crisis, republican ideology, state constitutions, slavery in the early republic, expansion, sectional conflict, the Civil War, or Reconstruction.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point for identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence,

such as the Declaration of Independence, republican motherhood, state voting rules, gradual emancipation laws, the Constitution's compromises over slavery, the Missouri Compromise, abolitionism, Seneca Falls, Dred Scott, emancipation, the Fourteenth Amendment, the Fifteenth Amendment, Black political participation during Reconstruction, or women's suffrage activism. Earns 2 points for using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about continuity and change over time.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining continuity and change over time, such as showing how citizenship expanded from property-holding white men toward birthright citizenship and Black male suffrage while many women, Native peoples, Chinese immigrants, and others remained excluded or contested.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by developing a nuanced argument, such as explaining that revolutionary ideals created language later used by excluded groups, that legal change did not always produce equal lived citizenship, that Reconstruction marked a major constitutional transformation but also produced backlash, or that citizenship changed differently across race, gender, class, and region.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should not simply list events from the Revolution to Reconstruction. It should develop a clear continuity-and-change argument about the meaning of citizenship. Strong evidence might include revolutionary republicanism, voting qualifications, abolitionism, women's rights activism, Dred Scott, emancipation, and the Reconstruction amendments. The best responses will show that citizenship expanded significantly in constitutional terms by 1877 while remaining contested and uneven in practice.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APUSH-FRQ1

· APUSH-SAQ1-001: Unit 2; Period 2: 1607–1754; perspectives include modern secondary historians of Chesapeake and New England colonial development; source type is paired secondary text interpretations; source viewpoints contrast plantation staple-crop labor hierarchy with diversified town-based New England economy; historical development is regional colonial economic and social formation; reasoning path is comparison based on environment, labor, religion, and commerce; misconception targeted is treating colonial regions as culturally different without explaining economic and environmental causes.

· APUSH-SAQ1-002: Unit 4; Period 4: 1800–1848; perspective is Cherokee community member resisting Georgia and removal pressure; source type is original simulated primary text; source viewpoint emphasizes treaties, sovereignty, Christianity, adaptation, and injustice of removal; historical development is Indian Removal and Native sovereignty in the Jacksonian era; reasoning path is POV/purpose/audience connected to federalism and state power; misconception targeted is portraying Native peoples as passive victims or assuming removal was only about migration.

· APUSH-SAQ1-003: Unit 8; Period 8: 1945–1980; perspectives include postwar homebuyers, federal mortgage systems, suburban families, central cities, and racially excluded borrowers; non-text source type is plain-text data table; visual/data pattern is suburban population, housing starts, highways, mortgage inequality, and city tax-base decline; historical development is postwar suburbanization and unequal access to homeownership; reasoning path is continuity and change over time linking policy, migration, and social consequences; misconception targeted is explaining suburbs only as private consumer choice.

· APUSH-DBQ1-001: Unit 6 primary with Unit 7 connections; Periods 6–7 / Cross-Period; DBQ topic is federal Native policy from allotment through the Indian New Deal, 1880s–1930s; document types include reform speech summary, Native parent letter, land-loss data table, western newspaper editorial, described boarding-school photograph, Native testimony, and New Deal policy summary; document perspectives include Protestant reformers, Native families, federal policy makers, non-Native settlers, school officials, Pueblo leadership, and New Deal administrators; main argument paths include land loss through allotment, assimilation through schooling, contested citizenship, Native resistance, and partial policy reversal under the Indian Reorganization era; outside evidence possibilities include Dawes Act, Carlisle Indian Industrial School, Ghost Dance, Wounded Knee, Curtis Act, Indian Citizenship Act, Meriam Report, and Indian Reorganization Act; sourcing opportunities include reformer paternalism, settler economic motive, staged school imagery, Native sovereignty claims, and New Deal critique of earlier federal policy; visual/data/map types include landholding data table and described boarding-school photograph.

· APUSH-LEQ1-001: Units 3–5; Periods 3–5 / Cross-Period; LEQ topic is changing ideas about citizenship from 1763 to 1877; historical reasoning process is continuity and change over time; evidence categories include revolutionary ideology, voting qualifications, republican motherhood, slavery and abolition, women’s rights, Dred Scott, emancipation, Reconstruction amendments, Black officeholding, and postwar backlash; complexity path is distinguishing constitutional citizenship from lived equality and comparing changes across race, gender, class, region, and legal status; misconception targeted is assuming citizenship expanded in a simple linear way for all groups.